

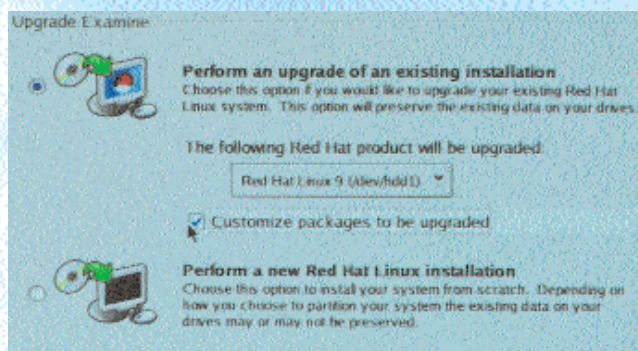
"Oops. I believe I just deleted my..."

There's a simple solution if you accidentally deleted everything on your system as root: Reinstall everything. Format and reinstall, but if you happened to wreak havoc over only one partition, try this: if you tried `'rm -rf *'` in the `/usr` directory, there is hope for you. Boot using the Red Hat 9 CDs, and choose the standard install option by pressing [Enter] at the prompt. Then choose to upgrade. Don't do a fresh install.

Over the next few screens, you'll be asked to enter some options about the upgrade software packages. Don't take a chance—install everything that you think you have lost. Once

done, the reinstall starts. The advantage of doing this versus a clean install is that your personal files are safe, as long as you don't choose to format.

On the other hand, keep in mind that if you happen to be the unlucky administrator of a machine hexed with root-kits, doing this may not be advisable. Instead, back up the data selectively after inspecting it, then clean format and reinstall Linux. You just cannot take a chance with tainted binaries and programs, and it is worth the effort to clean format from scratch and secure your machine, to ensure that the episode is not repeated.



Upgrading your Linux installation should get your box working



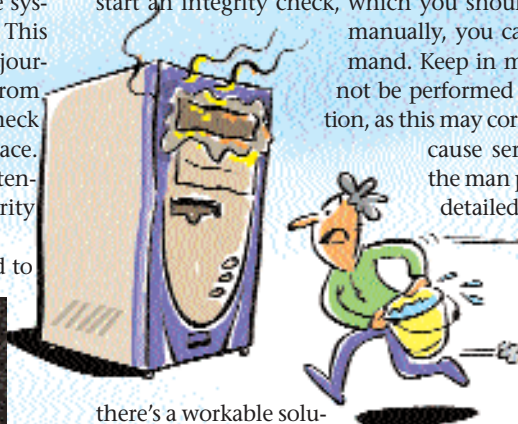
"Crash! Bang! Whiz! Fizzle. Ouch! Now what?"

The default Red Hat 9 file system is Ext3, a journaling file system that allows for quick recovery from hard drive crashes. This means that the entire sequence of hard drive operations is journaled (or recorded), which lets the file system recover from crashes much faster. For instance, a forced file system check does not always take place with the Ext3 file system in place. However, despite this, it's possible that errors and inconsistencies with the data on the hard drive may force an integrity check. Generally, this takes place automatically.

As the system boots up after a crash, you are prompted to

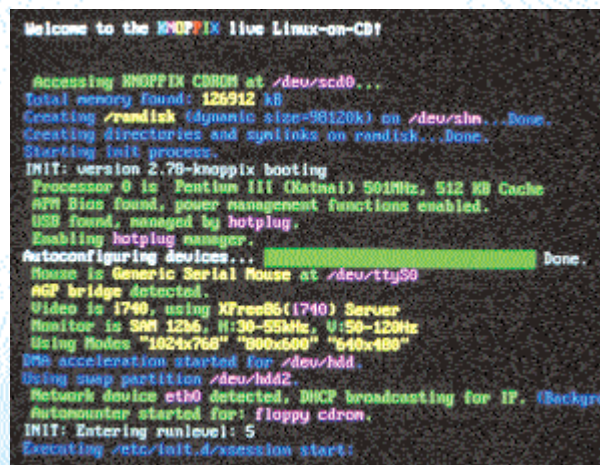
start an integrity check, which you should perform. To do so manually, you can use the `'fsck'` command. Keep in mind that `fsck` should not be performed on a mounted partition, as this may corrupt the contents and cause serious errors. Refer to the man page on `fsck` for more detailed usage instructions.

To copy essential data from a Linux installation that you may not be able to boot into or use,



there's a workable solution from Knoppix, the live boot CD distro. Of course, the data has to be readable. Also keep in mind that data recovery in case of a badly corrupted hard drive should be done by an expert.

For quick data recovery from a hard drive that's not badly damaged, boot into the Knoppix Linux distro. The nice thing about Knoppix is that it scans and configures your computer hardware on the fly, and automatically mounts FAT32 file systems. Once you boot into Knoppix, you should be able to read the contents of the hard drive and recover data onto another partition.



Boot into Knoppix and recover your data

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